# Bank of Leeds Strategic Infrastructure Proposal

# Humber Rail Renaissance Programme 2050

## A £6 Billion Railway Upgrade Programme for Yorkshire's Maritime Economy

**Prepared for:**
Bank of Leeds – Infrastructure & Regional Growth Division

**Investment Type:**
Long-term regional infrastructure investment

**Proposed Financing Instrument:**

# Bank of Leeds Humber Rail Infrastructure Bond

**Bond Duration:**

30–40 years

**Programme Cost:**

# £6 billion

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# Executive Summary

The Bank of Leeds proposes the creation of the **Humber Rail Renaissance Programme**, a comprehensive investment programme to modernise the railway infrastructure surrounding the Humber Estuary.

The objective:

> "Turn the Humber from a collection of disconnected port assets into Britain's most integrated northern logistics and industrial railway corridor."

The programme would upgrade:

- Hull passenger rail,
- Hull docks freight,
- Goole logistics connections,

- Immingham port rail,
- Grimsby connectivity,
- Scunthorpe steel freight routes,
- South Yorkshire links.

The investment would create:

- faster passenger journeys,
- increased freight capacity,
- stronger port competitiveness,
- reduced road congestion,
- support for offshore wind,
- industrial regeneration.

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# Strategic Context

The Humber is already one of Britain's most important trade regions.

The Humber ports complex handles a significant share of UK trade and includes major facilities at:

- Hull,
- Goole,
- Immingham,
- Grimsby.

The estuary is also central to offshore wind, chemicals and energy industries.

However, rail connectivity remains constrained.

Key issues include:

- insufficient freight gauge,
- limited passing capacity,
- bottlenecks around ports,
- incomplete electrification,
- weak east-west connectivity.

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# Investment Programme

# Humber Rail Renaissance Network

## Total Investment

# £6 billion

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# Project 1

# Hull Rail Gateway Upgrade

## Investment:

## £1.2 billion

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## Objective

Transform Hull from a terminal railway city into a regional rail hub.

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## Works:

### Hull Paragon Station Upgrade

Investment:

£250m

Improvements:

- additional platforms,
- improved passenger facilities,
- commercial development.

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### Hull Dock Rail Upgrade

Investment:

£400m

Create:

## Hull Maritime Freight Terminal

Capabilities:

- containers,
- offshore wind components,
- manufacturing logistics.

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### Hull–Selby–Leeds Corridor Upgrade

Investment:

£550m

Works:

- electrification,
- signalling,
- track improvements.

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# Benefits

Journey improvements:

Hull → Leeds

Current:

~55 minutes

Target:

40–45 minutes

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# Project 2

# Goole Logistics Rail Hub

## Investment:

## £900 million

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Goole is strategically important because it connects:

- rail,
- inland waterways,
- road,
- Humber ports.

The Environment Agency identifies Goole as an important interface between rail, road, the Humber estuary and inland waterways.

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# Proposal

Create:

# Yorkshire Intermodal Freight Hub

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Facilities:

- 750m freight sidings,
- container terminal,
- warehouse district,
- rail freight village.

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Capacity:

500,000 containers/year potential.

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Economic Impact:

Creates:

- logistics jobs,
- manufacturing supply chains,
- export capability.

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# Project 3

# Immingham Port Rail Expansion

## Investment:

## £1.5 billion

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Immingham is one of Britain's largest ports.

The challenge:

Port growth requires better rail capacity.

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## Works:

### Freight Capacity Expansion

£600m

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### W12 Loading Gauge Upgrade

£300m

Allows:

- modern containers,
- larger freight wagons.

Current assessments highlight gauge restrictions affecting Humber port growth.

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### Immingham Rail Terminal Expansion

£600m

Create:

- automated freight handling,
- electrified sidings,
- increased train frequency.

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# Project 4

# Grimsby Coastal Rail Renaissance

## Investment:

## £750 million

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## Objective

Reconnect Grimsby economically with:

- Hull,
- Lincoln,
- Sheffield,
- Yorkshire.

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Works:

- line upgrades,
- station improvements,
- freight connections.

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New services:

## Hull → Grimsby

Target:

25 minutes

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## Grimsby → Sheffield

Target:

45 minutes

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# Project 5

# Humber Freight Spine

## Investment:

## £1 billion

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Create a strategic freight route:

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Immingham
  |
Scunthorpe
  |
Doncaster
  |
Sheffield
  |
Midlands
```

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Works:

- track doubling,
- signalling,
- electrification,
- freight loops.

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Benefits:

Removes freight from roads.

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# Project 6

# Humber Passenger Rail Network

## Investment:

## £650 million

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Create a regional passenger network.

New routes:

## Hull–Goole

Fast commuter service

## Hull–Immingham

New industrial commuter route

## Hull–Grimsby

Coastal connectivity

## Beverley–Hull–Lincoln

Regional growth corridor

# Capital Breakdown

| Project | Investment |
|---|---|
| Hull Gateway | £1.2bn |
| Goole Freight Hub | £900m |
| Immingham Expansion | £1.5bn |
| Grimsby Rail Upgrade | £750m |
| Freight Spine | £1bn |
| Passenger Network | £650m |

# Total:

# £6 billion

# Bank of Leeds Bond Structure

# Humber Rail Renaissance Bond

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## Initial Issue

£2 billion

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## Duration

35 years

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## Investors

- pension funds,
- insurance companies,
- infrastructure funds,
- regional investors.

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# Revenue Model

The railway itself is not justified purely by ticket income; the investment case is based on wider economic returns.

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# Direct Revenue

## Freight Charges

Assumption:

20 million tonnes/year

Average access revenue:

£8/tonne

Revenue:

£160m/year

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## Passenger Revenue

Additional journeys:

10 million/year

Average fare:

£12

Revenue:

£120m/year

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## Property Development

Around:

- Hull station,
- Goole freight hub,
- port districts.

Potential:

£500m+

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# Total Annual Revenue Potential

Approximately:

# £300–400 million/year

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# Economic Benefits

## Construction Employment

20-year programme:

# 40,000 job-years

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## Permanent Jobs

Direct:

5,000

Indirect:

15,000+

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# GDP Impact

Estimated regional uplift:

# £1.5–3 billion annually

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Generated by:

- port expansion,
- logistics,
- manufacturing,
- offshore wind,
- tourism,
- housing development.

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# Industrial Benefits

## Sheffield

Improved access to:

- steel,
- engineering,
- advanced manufacturing.

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## Hull

Becomes:

- maritime logistics hub,
- offshore wind centre.

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## Goole

Becomes:

- inland port,
- Yorkshire logistics capital.

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## Immingham

Strengthened as:

- energy gateway,
- industrial port.

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# Strategic Integration

The Humber Rail Renaissance would complement:

## Renewable Energy Strategy

Supporting:

- offshore wind,
- hydrogen,
- tidal energy.

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## Yorkshire Manufacturing Strategy

Supporting:

- steel,
- machinery,
- exports.

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## Agricultural Strategy

Supporting:

- food logistics,
- cold storage,
- rural exports.

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# Risk Assessment

## Cost Overruns

Mitigation:

- phased delivery,
- private-sector participation.

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## Freight Demand

Mitigation:

Design around:

- ports,
- energy,
- manufacturing.

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## Passenger Demand

Mitigation:

Focus on:

- commuter flows,
- industrial employment,
- tourism.

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# Delivery Timeline

## Phase 1: 2026–2032

£1.5bn

- Hull upgrades
- Goole development
- freight gauge works

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## Phase 2: 2032–2040

£3bn

- Immingham expansion

- freight spine
- electrification

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### Phase 3: 2040–2050

£1.5bn

- passenger network
- additional capacity

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# Final Recommendation

The Bank of Leeds should establish:

# Humber Rail Renaissance Development Corporation

and issue:

# £2 Billion

# 35-Year Humber Rail Infrastructure Bond

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# Final Investment Thesis

The Humber is one of Britain's greatest underused economic assets.

The region already has:

- ports,
- energy,
- industry,
- workforce,
- geography.

The missing ingredient is connectivity.

The Bank of Leeds opportunity is:

> **To build the railway infrastructure that turns the Humber from a group of separate ports into a unified northern economic gateway.**

A £6 billion rail investment could create the transport backbone for Yorkshire's next industrial century.